

Swansea Branch, England Southwest Mission. *Confidential Minutes, 1849-1881.*

#46

Church Archives call number: LR 8863 10

Record of council meetings from 1877 to 1881. Includes membership information from 1849 to 1870.

Until 1866 branch was known as Abertawe.

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— some pages in Welsh need translations
} not the same as #32

1879

Elder Hugh Watson Presiding 5

District Council Meeting held in the 1 Saints hall Baptist Court June 8th 1879

Meeting Opened By Singing Hymn 132 Prayer by Elder W Williams Singing Come all ye Sons of God the minutes of the last Council were Passed and Brother T. Thoman Reported the visiting of Brothers Lavander and Evan Williams according to the appointment of the last Council they felt to Come and make a fresh Start Elder Williams Reported the Swansea Branch in good Condition meetings well attended Both by Saints and Strangers for which he felt to Rejoice Elder Laing Represented the Neath Branch as in Rather a depressed Condition he having only two Elders and they Both neglecting their duty but he felt to do his duty in the kingdom of God

President Watson Spoke to us on our duties in our fathers kingdom he felt to ask Gods Blessings to Rest upon us meeting was Closed by Singing and Prayer By Elder T Thomas

Swansea District Council Meeting Held in the Saints Hall Baptist Court July 13th 1879~

Prst John G. Jones Presiding Meeting Opened By Singing Come all ye saints of God Prayer by Elder William. J. Williams Singing him 163 the minutes of the last Council were read and accepted the case of Bro Lavender and Evan Williams Bro Moroni Watts Spoke as to the Condition of those Brethren when he visited them Brother William. J. Williams asked for a month to be enabled to see them Prt John G. Jones felt to give Brother one month as he wished for Bro Jones felt to reorganise the Branch by appointing Elder Thomas Thomas as first and Elder Moroni Watts as Second Councilors So Prt Williams those Brethren were Sustained unanous and spoke of the duty of the officers to be very prompt and careful and wise in our Council to the saints showed the workings of the Spirit that were opposed to us and the kingdom of God he felt to say God bless you all amen Elder Joseph R. Mathews endorsed the words of Prts John G. Jones and bore testimony that Spirit of God was in our midst spoke of his experience in the kingdom of God Prts Jones brought forward the case of Evan James for spreading evil report about the Brethren and he did not think he was fit to be in the church but felt to give him fair play it was moved that he be disfellowshipped until he make things right and if he

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do not he will be Cut off from the Church this day month Elder Moroni Watts and William. J. Williams was appointed to see him and tell him the decision of the Council Prts Jones spoke on the law of Tithing and the Blessing attending those that observed the same praying that the blessings of God to be with you amen Council Closed by Singing hymn 259 Prayer by William Williams

Sunday April 13th 1879 Meeting open by Singing Come all ye Sones of God Prayer By Elder Thomas Thomas Singing Prts John G. Jones Call on Prts Williams to report the Swansea branch in good condition with a few exceptions Prts Jones gave the Brethren the chance to state their feelings Bro Fowler brought the case of his Brother for drunkenness and neglect of duty after hearing the testimony in the case Prts Jones gave us some good instruction on our duties it was moved and seconded that William Fowler be Cut off from the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints for drunkenness and bad conduct carried unanous Moroni Watts brought forward the case of Sister Ann

Parry for conduct unbecoming for a saint after giving the Brethren a chance to speak their feelings on the case Prts Jones spok to Brethren and advise them to give her another Chance to repent and advise us to have the spirit of god so that we would be able to teach those that are weak in the faith, he appointed Bro James Fowler and Thomas Thomas to see Sister Parry

Prayer by Elder. William. Williams 1 Seventy 5 Elders 1 Member

Sunday May 1879 District Council Meeting held in the Sants Hall
Babtist Court Elder John. G. Jones presiding Open by singing Come all ye sones of god
Prayer by Elder Joseph. R. Mathews singing hymn 163 the munits of last Council redd
and passed Elder William. Williams reported the Swansea branch he reported Brother
Evan Williams and Alfred Lavander for neglect of duty Elder John G. Jones said that he
did not feel to deal with Bro Williams untill two of the Brethren visit him also for two to
visit Brother Lavander and talk to them with the spirit of love Elder Joseph. R. Mathews
spoke on the same subject Bro Moroni Watts and Thomas Thomas were appointed to
visit them Brother Lang Reported the Neath Branch in good sstanding as a rule and trying
to keep the commandments of God 1 Seventy 7 Elders Dismiss by Elder James Fowler

Swansea Aug 11th 1879 Minutes of a District Council held in L. D. Saints Hall
Baptist Court President John G. Jones Presiding Elder Joseph. R. Mathews Evan Wride
and David Bowen traveling Elders in the Welsh Conference Prest Jones Call the meeting
to order Prayer offered by J. R. Mathews Upon Motion J. R. Mathews was elected secy^r
of the meeting Prest Jones then detailed the order of the Priesthood and courts of the
Church in dealing with its members or officers in corse of neglect of duty or departing
from the truth or anything that is contrary to law and good Order said thess their was a
charge prefered against

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President Williams of the Swansea Branch for misapplying and using for his own use
Tithing money that had been Subscribed by members of the church to settle Hall Rents
and Conference Expences and c? and for such offence was yesterday Released by the
President of the Conference as as President of the Swansea Branch of the Chruch Brother
Williams arose and acknowledged the charge against him that he had use some of the
money oweing to hard times and being out of Employment &c Bro Moroni Watts made
a Statement in regard to the finance account of the Branch showing according to the
Books of the Land Lady that thay were considerable in arrears in the Rent Prest.
Williams made a few remarks said that he felt greived that he had committed himself in
takeing the money that did not belong to him and using it to other purposes then that
intended and asked the foregiveness of this meeting for so doing Several of the Brethren
made remarks upon various Points in regard to finance and of a Spirit of fault finding
backbiting & Evil Speaking that was manifest in the Branch among certain individuals
&c Prest Jones made a few remarks was pleased to see such an Excellent Spirit prevailing
this evening had no desire to hurt the feelings of any man had no hare feeling against
Prest. Williams that it was through his influence he was put into the Position he occupied
and according to Bro Williams desire in asking forgiveness he felt in his heart & pardon
and forgive him Bro. J. R. Mathews said he diplicated the manner that things had
occurred yesterday had exercise his faith and Prayers that this meeting would result in
good to all that a wrong had been committed was evident but it the Bro Charged

therewith was with the help of some of his Brethren willing to make it right he was in favour of foregiveing him Bro Wride and Bowen reiterated the sentiments of Bro Mathews said thay had never seen in all thair lives Such disgracefull proceedings as was enacted yesterday in meeting but felt in thair hearst to forgive all the parties for so doing it was moved and carried unanimously that one months time be allowed Bro Williams to make Settlement & Liquidate the indebtedness of the Hall Rent and that he his not entitled to act in his office in the Pristhood untill he has done so Prest J. G. Jones also prefered a charge against Bro Moroni Watts for makeing false accusation insulting and useing unbecoming language to him yesterday the Sabbath while in meeting and afterwards Bro Watts admitted to the Charge and confessed his faults and wrong doing to Bro Jones & the saints and by vote of the meeting was pardon for so doing Bro Thomas Thomas and Jane Watts also admitted to giving away to timper manner & language unbecomeing a Saint and was foregiven by the meeting Bro Moroni Watts then made a statement that Bro Thomas Thomas had on one ocasion given him offence in language and misconduct as presiding officer of the meeting in the absence of Prest Williams for which he had never asked forgiveness or made right and commenced to detail the affair but digressing from the subject point was call to order by the Prest and requested to take his seat untill Prest explained the question which he declined to so Saying he would not! and then commenced on a tirade of offences alleged

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To have been committed by others individuals, was constantly called to order but refused to obey Saying it was a completely onesided affair and thay could get no justice in this Council and would appeal to the Prest of the mission showing no true repentance of former transaction in his attitude and conduct this evning Prest Jones then moved that Moroni Watts be cut off the church of Jesus Christ of L. D. Saints for misconduct and defiant manner to the Pristhood while in this meeting motion carried ays 12 nays 6- The meeting was then disturbed by several arising to leave and Prest Williams Wife comeing into the roome and creating much confusion in using language unbecoming and in creating disorder among the women by loud talking &c- in being impossible to restore Order the meeting came to a close and much Commotion

Swansea Aug 12th 1879

At a meeting of the Saints held in the usual place Bro William Parkhouse and Francis Allen were ordained Elders in the Church of Jesus Christ of L. D. Saints And a Reorganization of the Swansea Branch was affected as followes, Presidant William Parkhouse 1st Counlor Thomas Thomas 2^{and} Francis Allen the vote being unanimous to Sustain them in thair position by our faith and prayers the meeting was thrown open for those who desired to ask the forgiveness of the Saints for their Trespasses and wrong doings as Saints of God Bro Alma Watts, Jane Watts and Anne Reese asked ther Pardon and forgiveness of all the Saints for all things done amiss in word deed or action to injure the feeling of the Brothren and Sisters, Presidant Jones Presented the case of Moroni Watts stating that he had been Excommunicated from the Church of Jesus Christ of L. D. Saints in a council held the preivous Evning for misconduct and disobediance to the Pristhood and in showing no true repentance for acts committed on the previous Sabbath in insulting and using very Unbecoming language the desision of the council was sustained by Unaminous vote of the Saints present Elder Jones, Mathews, Wride & Bowen made remarks appropriate to the occosaun and urged the Saints to faithfulness in

Sustaining the Pristhood and presiding officers By our faith & Prayers Sang hymn
Benidiction.

Swansea Sept 14th 1879.

Minutes of a District Council held in L. D. Saints Hall Baptist Court on above date.

Presidint J. G. Jones presideing Sang hymn

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prayer offered by Elder J. R. Mathews. Minutes of District Council held Aug 11th were read and by majority vote approved. In the matter of Bro W^m Williams. for using the Tithing money on a previous Occasion. was considered, and as times were hard and he was unable to meet his obligations to settle the Hall Rents in the allotted time of one month. And as all the Priesthood were in favor of Extending the time to one month longer. It was so carried. President Parkhouse made a few remarks on Branch business, Said that Bro T. Thomas, had been teaching On Some doctrine that was not Scriptural. And as some of the people of the world were present. It Caused some talk among them, and the Saints-Which should be avoided. Bro Thomas Admitted that probably he did say something that was not entirily Scriptural, but it was not Intentional, As he wished to do what was right in the sight of the Lord & his Brotheren. A difficulty having arisen between Bro Thomas & Watts. Thy desired to ask each others forgiveness and make it right, which was done. Extending to each other the hand of fellowship. Bros Wride and Mathews made a few remarks upon the duties of the Saints in general & spoke of the necessity of being very careful in our teachings upon principals of life and Salvation. And not enter into the mysteries or more advanced principals of the Gospel, but Confine ourselves to first principals. Prest.. Jones gave some timely Council and advise. And meeting came to a Close Benediction by Elder Evan Wride=By J. R. M Clerk

Swansea October 12th 1879.

No Council held oweing to other pressing business in the Conference requiring the presence of the Prest..

Swansea NovEmber 9th 1879.

Minutes of District held in Usual place Baptist Court. President J. G. Jones presiding Sang hymn, prayer offered by Elder Watson. minutes of Council held Septth 14th 1879. were read and accepted. Swansea Branch was reported by Prest.. Parkhouse, & Elder T. Thomas as in good Condition with few Esceptions. Neath Brach was represented by Prestth Ges Lang. As in medium Condition. Our of a Noth of 25th 10 were attending to their duties. As for himself desired to Continue in well doing. In the Case of Bro W^m Williams who had been notified to appear here this morning to show Cause why he should not be dealt with, On Certain Charges &cth. It was moved and & Carried that on account of a Certain reason Expressed. The time be extended untill tomorrow Monday Evening to Answer Said Charges. In the matter of W^m. J. Williams which was brought up for false Charges in Certain Correspondence to Prest Budge &cth. Bro Williams admitted that he had allowed his name to be attached to the letters mentioned. But that there were Certain Paragraphs therein Contained that he knew nothing of. Bro Alma Watts made a few remarks said, He was sorry to know that his name was put to those letters &c. But was not aware of Certain

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verses mentioned. Elder J. R. Mathews made few remarks. Upon the Contents of those letters. And gave Admonition to those Implicated= Elder E. Lewis just arrived from Utah. made a few excellent remarks upon the blessings the Saints enjoy and of their obligations to God and the Priesthood. Elder H. Watson, Suggested the propriety of the Bretheren. making all things right forthwith. Bro W. J. Williams arose and asked the forgiveness of this Council an for his Actions in signing those letters to Prest^r Budge & Elder W. J. Lewis. It was moved and Carried that the forgiveness of this Council & Pristhood be accorded him. In the Case of Alma Watts on same Charge, the same by unanimous vote ^{was} accorded him through repentance & forgiveness. Prest Jones. & Elder Wride gave a few Instructive remarks to the brethren adviseing them to be very Cautious in the future in allowing their names to be used to documents that they are Ignorant of their Contents.

After Singing hymn Meeting Came to a close Benediction by Elder Enoch Lewis.

Swansea NovEmber 10th 1879.

Minutes of Special Council held in Usual place. Nov 10th 1879. Presidint Jones Presiding. A letter was produced bearing the Sig-nature of certain bretheren in Swansea Branch to Prest^r Budge & W. J. Lewis. which was read, and some false charges against the Lr^r Elders was therein contained=Bro W^m Williams was asked if he was aware his name was in those Letters to which he said Yes. And tried to justify himself in the Course taken. Elder H. Watson made a few remarks, Said Bro Williams was not possessed of a Spirit of repentance, gave him good Council and Advise, to Repent and seek forgiviness of this Council. Elder Mathews & E. Lewis, made timly suggestions to same effect. giving good Admonition & Council. Bro Williams arose and made Confessions to his wrongs in signing those letters &c^r. And upon his Repentance was forgiven by the Priesthood. On the 2nd Charge. of Non-Compliance with settling Hall Rents &c^r as previously agreed to. It was moved and Carried that the former decision of the Council stand valid with the addition that Bro Williams be allowed to partake of the Sacrament and testify in the meetings. Adjourned Benediction by E. Lewis

Swansea DECember 14th 1879.

Minutes of District Council held in L. D. Saints Hall^r "Baptist Court" President Jones presiding prayer by Elder D-Bowen. Minutes of last Council read and unanimously Approved. The Swansea Branch was reported by Prest^r Parkhouse in good Condition with few Exceptions. Bros T. Thomas & Alma Watts brought up the Case of Sisters Janues and Schouler. Prest Jones gave good Instructions of the principals of the Gospel. And also Instructed the priesthood to foreward written notices to Sister James & Lchouler, to attend a Council after the Evening meeting was over to Investigate their Case. Prest^r Parkhouse brought up the Case of Bro Francis Allen who wished to resign his Office as 2nd Councilor to Prest^r Parkhouse. Prest Jones made remarks upon the duties of the Elders. And to be very lenient

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to Bro Allen, and to labor with him. The meeting came to a close after a few remarks by Elder E. Lewis. A. Watts & Tho^s Thomas. Benediction.

Swansea January 11th 1880.

Minutes of District Council held in L. D. Saints Hall Baptist Court Jan 11th 1880. Elder E. Lewis presiding. Sang hymn prayer by Bro Tho^s Thomas. Elder Lewis, gave instructions on the duties of the priesthood. And to keep them-selves guiltless from the world. Elder T. Thomas Reported the Branch as in its usual condition. Bro Alma Watts arose and made acknowledgement of transgressing the laws of the Church, by takeing strong drink. &c. Elder Bowen made a few remarks on the duties of Elders, to keep themselves from transgressions, And not to be stumbling blocks in the way of the honest who are seeking after truth, It was moved and Carried, that Bro Watts, be forgiven on Conditions to abstain from such habits in the future – Bro W. J. Williams made a few remarks and the meeting Came to a Close, Benediction by Elder David Bowen.

Swansea February 8th 1880.

Minutes of District Council held in the Saints Hall, usual place & time. Prest. J. G. Jones presiding. Elders. Mathews & Lewis present. Sang "Come all ye Sons of God &c." prayer by Elder Lewis. Minutes of previous Council Accepted as read. Prest. Parkhouse. represented Swansea Branch as in better Condition, were visiting the Saints, and encourageing them to attend to their duties, all of them manifesting a desire to do so; A good Spirit prevailed generally. Prest. Geo, Lang represented Neath branch as in a precarious Condition that the Elders there did not live up to their calling in the Priesthood, which threw all the work upon him, they were holding meetings, the Sisters Comeing together from time to time and they felt well. The Committee who were appointed to wait upon Bro. Allen. reported their visit to the Effect, that he was dissatisfied with persons that were attending the meetings and were in Authority, And unless they were removed he would not attend any more. It appears by the testimony of the Elders that Certain other Irregularities are the Causes of his seeming Indifference, that he gives way to the ways of the world, and it is Impossible to Extricate himself. Prest. Jones suggested leniancy in his Case for the time being. By unanimous vote it was decided to give him an Indefinite period of time to restore himself. Several Questions were asked, in relation to Doctrine, &c. which was answered. Elder Lewis Said it was a duty devolveing upon us to live pure and upright lives, that the Holy Ghost may have place to dwell in us. to magnify our prishood to the good of all. Prest Jones suggested that in our forthcomeing council we Cultivate the Spirit of God, and Come together in the Spirit of Enjoyment and leave off our super-stitious ways, and we then can go and have good time of enjoyment, together. Sang "God moves in a Mesterious way &c"

Benediction by Elder George Lang. J. R. Mathews Clerk

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1880

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Swansea March 14" 1880.

Minutes of district Council held in usual place, on March 14" 1880. Prest. J. G. Jones. presideing sang hymn on page 143 prayer by Elder Tho^s Thomas. Prest. Parkhouse represented the Branch as in medium Condition. Prest. Jones made a few appropriate remarks. Elder E. Lewis gave an Interesting account of his labors during the past month, which was Encourageing. After a few remarks by the Bretheren meeting Came to a Close, Benediction by Elder Enoch Lewis { Seventies 2 Elders 3 Total=5=

Swansea April 11th 1880.

Minutes of a District Council held in Saints Hall. Elder E Lewis Presiding Sang Hymn on page 180 Prayer by Elder David ~~Elder~~ bowen sang on page 168 Elder Lewis made a few remarks upon sustaining the preisthood~the minutes of Previous Council held march

the 14th were read and approved Elder thomas thomas represented the Swansea branch has in good Condition particularly those who were living their religion Elccellent time enjoyed during the Jubille – there was those who were still in the back track and were in lack of the spret of the Lord Elder lewis gave a bynopsis of his travels during the past month which was very good had made good progress baptized three persons during the month. Elder David Bowen made a few remarks giving his Experince during the past month had held a great number of meetings and experinced a good time generally. in regard to the matter of francis allen mentioned in a previous minutes. he having emigrated to America his case was letp to be submitted to the next Council in may Elder Mathews made a few remarks relating to a Circular that has been issued to the conference President requesting the Priesthood to admonish the saints in the necessity of paying their tiding and book money &c and to live their religion that thy may receice the favour and blessing of the allmighty. Closed by singing hymn Benediction By Elder Jas R Mathews John James Clerk

Swansea May 9th 1880

Minutes of a District meeting at the saints saints hall Baptist court President J g Jones Presiding sang hymn on page 180 prayer by Elder David Bowen President Parkhouse reported the Swansea Branch in good Condition the Case of francis allan was brought before the Council and reported that he had emigrated to an Canada. President Jones made some ~~some~~ good remark an on the duties of the Priesthood o in a very Comprehensive an instructive manner, Brother Lang reported the Neath branch in good condition of a few that did not attend meetting as faithful as they ought do do Bro =E

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1880

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Lewis made a few remarks and an history of his last months travels and success during his visits amongst the saints the Council was brought to a close prayer by Elder Lewis 1 High priest 2 Seveny 3 Elders John Jones Clerk

Swansea June 13th 1880

Minutes of a District Council held at the saints hall Brethen from utah Elder Lewis hymn on page 180 by brother Lang ~~president~~ prayer by president parkhouse reported Swansea Branch in good Condition Brothe Lang president of Neath Branch reported a few of the saints were not living up to their religion but their were a few Sisters that were very faithful and he Baptized on Brother and he felt well with the Church of god Brother Lewis made a few remarks hoping that the ~~the~~ saints would pay their tithings as much as they Could afford Council lwas brought to a close by singing on page 73 Prayer by Elder Lewis 1 Seventy 4 Elders 1 Deacon John James Clerk

Swansea July 11th 1880

Minuets of Districts council held at the saints hall on Sunday Hymn on page 143 President Parkhouse reported that a few of the Swansea Sisters were very Backward in attending to there meetings and there was a great-deal of ill feeling between afew of the saints but hoping that the Lord would bless them that they may be united again Brother Lang president of the Neath Branch reported the Branch to be very Backward that he visited a few saints Brother Eastman complained of having no fit Clothes to attend Brother Newman was very neglectful not for the want of Clothes but real neglect Brother Lewis made a few remarks hoping the Brething would co work together and go round and visit a few of the saints Council was brought to a Close by singing on page 163 prayer by Brother Lang 1 Seventy 4 Elders 1 Deacon John Jame Clerk

1880

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Swansea Aug. 8th 1880.

Minutes of a District Council. held at Saints hall. President J. R. Matthews Presiding, Sang hym on page 180. Prayer by Elder Enoch Lewis. minutes of Council held July 11th 1880 were read and by unanimous vote accepted. President Parkhouse represented the Swansea Branch as in similar Condition as one month ago Some of the saints were backward and not living their religion. while those who were felt well and enjoyed the Spirit of the Gospel, was satisfied, this was the work of Jehovah, and felt to Continue in the same, Elder George Lang Priesndent of Neath branch, reported the same us in better Condition than formerley, more union was the result, and they enjoyed much of holy spirit of God, and reported that their was a prospect of Baptisms in their neighbourhood, believing their was many honest hea'ted in Neath, and was desirious of watching them, Elder E Lewis made a few remarks on unioun. of Preisthood, and showed that with out the same we could not accomplish the work of God, Priest=Matthews Said he felt well to hear the reports this morning, and made a few remarks upon the order of the Preisthood, and our true Position as the agents of God, and exhorted all to union fellowships, love and charity, to do our several duties manfully and in ^{the} fear of god, Council ~~Council~~ Closed, Prayer by J R Matthews seventys 1 Elders 6 Deacons 1 John James Clerk

Swansea Sep. 12th 1880

Minutes of District Council held at the Latterday Saints hall Baptist Court Elder Enoch Lewis Presiding. hymn on page 51. prayer by Elder E Lewis. Hymn on page 180. minutes of Council held aug. 8th 1880 were read over and accepted, President Parkhouse represented the Swansea Branch, and reported it to be in better Condition this week or two than a month ago he felt well with the church of God. he reported that Brother T Thomas had been absent 6 sundays afternoon meetings, last sunday brother Thomas came and would take his place, Brother Parkhouse having suspended him a week previous, and the consequence was that their were no meeting, all the saints present went out. Brother Evans made a few remarks hoping the Bretheren would lift another up, and not pull one another down rather suffer wrong than do wrong. and try and help each other as much as possible, Brother T Thomas said the reason he did not attend was becauce his wife being very ill. admmitted he used rash words. when. Brother Parkhouse. said he was suspended, but felt very sorry for the same but now his wife and children were gone to utah he would try to attend his meettings more regular. Brother E Lewis said he felt sorry to hear it. but he knew that sister thomas had been very ill but he hoped they would make it up, brother Parkhouse said he had no ill ~~ne~~ feeling against brother thomas. he thought he was doing his duty when he suspendidg brother thomas Brother E Lewis said that Brother budge told him that Presidents had no authority to suspend the Elders. if the

1880

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do not do their duty tell them of it and if they dont come round must take action towards them and let him be dealt with Brother John Lewis said he thought that Brother Thomas was trying to Justify himself in doing wrong last monday night, they had a meeting brother thomas came in a took up a book to commence the meeting and Lewis told him he had no wright to commence the meeting and thomas said a Puplic house meeting and Brother John Lewis walked out and all the saints followed him. Leaving thom^{as} by

himself what he called him on monday. he would forgive him, he had seen thomas ^{come} in to a meeting and take up a book and say we will have ^{some} sort of a meeting. he had been to meeting and went home to his Lodgings and seen Brother Thomas and his wife there and. if he could go there and not come to his meetings he was no fit man to be a first councillor Brother E Lewis asked if Brother Parkhouse would forgive Brother Thomas. Brother Parkhouse said he had ill feeling against him Brother Watts forgave Brother Thomas for calling him what he did. council brought to a close by singing on page 198. Prayer by Elder Evans 2 seventys 5 elders 3 Deacons John James Clerk

Swansea Oct 10th 1880

Minutes of a District Council held at the Latterday Saints hall Baptist Court. president J R Matthews presiding Elders from Zion President Enoch Lewis J Bowen & Edwin harmon=singing hymn on page 163 prayer offered by Elder E Lewis. sang hymn on page 159 minutes of Council held sept 12th were read over and ammended and accepted The matter of the suspensio of Elder Thomas Thomas was brought up and discussed Pro & con= and as the Branch was not fully organised it was held that the act of suspension was not legal and was Countermanded. Brother thomas Retaining his former standing in the Church Bro= Thomas & J Lewis settled a little misunderstanding between them extending to each other the haⁿd of Brotherhood Elder E lewis made remarks upon our duties in the Priesthood & Brother George Lang represented the Neath Branch in good Condition and and Excellent spirits. Prest. J R Matthews gave some remarks on Priesthood and Branch organizations and duties of Branch Presidents differing how far they were Justified in suspending members &c and said it is to be understood that Brother E lewis as travelling Elder in this District was the Prest of said District and should be Consulted on all buisness of importance. Councilled all to live and magnify their Calling and Priesthood as Elders in Israel sang Prayer by Elder J Bowen Seventies 3 Elders 8 Deacons 3 John James ?

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1880

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Swansea Nov 18th 1880

Minutes of a District Council held L D Saints hall Baptist Council Elder E Lewis Presiding sang hymn on page 58 Prayer by Elder E lewis singing on page 57 minutes of Council held Oct 10th were read over and accepted Prest Parkhouse reported the Swansea Branch and said that a few of the saints were very backward in attending to their afternoon meetings but they enjoyed a Good meeting on sunday nights but he hoped those that were backward would soon Come round. Elder George Lang represented the Neath Branch and reported it to be in very Good Condition that they enjoyed much of the holy spirit. Brother Bowen reported his travels during the last month and said he enjoyed himself very much they had a very nice meeting in Both Cardigan and Carmethen in the last month Brother Evans gave some Excellent remarks pertaining to the duties of the missionaries Council was brought to a Close by singing on page 165 Prayer by Brother M J Thomas seventys 6 Elders 6 Deacons 2 John James Clerk

Swansea Dec 12th 1880

Minutes of District council held in usual place Elder E Lewis Presiding sang hymn on page 180 Prayer by Elder Bowen sang hymn on page 143 ?minutes of Council held Nov 18th were read over and accepted President Parkhouse reported the Swansea Branch in bad Condition but he hoped it would soon be better Elder George Lang reported the Neathe Branch as in good Condition But their were a few sisters that didnt pay but he

thought they done their best Elder E Lewis made a few remarks and said that had some excellent meetings last week. President Parkhouse said he called a Council last Sunday week but no one came and he called Brother W J Williams to administer the ordinance but he did not feel to do it Council was brought to a close by singing on page 166

John James Clerk
Swansea Jan 9th 1881

Minutes of a District Council held as usual place Elder Enoch Lewis Presiding Elders Present from Zion Bother Bowen sang hymn on page 180 Prayer by Elder Bowen Sang hymn on page 163 minutes of Council held on Sunday Dec 12th were read over and accepted President Parkhouse was not present to represent the Swansea Branch the Case of Brother Alma Watts was brought before the Council he having been suspended from the Priesthood but not from being a member. Watts said he was very sorry for what had transpired but he

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1881

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was determined to go on better in the future than in the past Brother Enoch Lewis moved that Brother Watts be forgiven and was seconded by Brother Bowen and Carried by the rising of the right hand some excellent remarks were given by Elder E Lewis and Bowen Council was brought to a close by singing on page 57 Prayer by Elder Thomas Thomas seventies 2 Elders 2 Deacons 2 John James Clerk

Sunday March 13th 1881

Minutes of a District Council held at L D saints hall Baptist Court Elder Enoch Lewis Presiding sang hymn on page 180 Prayer by Elder E Lewis singing hymn on page 163 President Lang was not present to represent the Neath Branch Brother Enoch Lewis said that when he left the Neath Branch a fortnight ago they were enjoying much of the holy spirit Elder William J Williams reported the Swansea Branch to be in a very bad Condition that there were but a few saints attending to their afternoon meetings some excellent instructions were given by Brother Benjamin Harmon he prayed that God would bless all the saints and that they may come round and live in peace and happiness some excellent remarks were also given by Elders Bowen and ——— Edwin Harmon Council was brought to a close by singing on page 166 Benediction by Elder Alma Watts. seventies 4 Elders 3 Priest 1 Deacon 1 John James Clerk

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